



General Assembly

February Session, 2026

Raised Bill No. 5290

LCO No. 1571



Referred to Committee on PLANNING AND DEVELOPMENT

Introduced by:
(PD)

***AN ACT CONCERNING COASTAL SITE PLAN REVIEWS FOR
CERTAIN SINGLE-FAMILY RESIDENTIAL STRUCTURES.***

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General Assembly convened:

1 Section 1. Subsection (b) of section 22a-109 of the 2026 supplement to
2 the general statutes is repealed and the following is substituted in lieu
3 thereof (*Effective October 1, 2026*):

4 (b) The zoning commission may by regulation exempt any or all of
5 the following uses from the coastal site plan review requirements of this
6 chapter: (1) Minor additions to or modifications of existing buildings or
7 detached accessory buildings, such as garages and utility sheds; (2)
8 construction of new or modification of existing structures incidental to
9 the enjoyment and maintenance of residential property including but
10 not limited to walks, terraces, elevated decks, driveways, swimming
11 pools, tennis courts, docks and detached accessory buildings; (3)
12 construction of new or modification of existing on-premise structures
13 including fences, walls, pedestrian walks and terraces, underground
14 utility connections, essential electric, gas, telephone, water and sewer
15 service lines, signs and such other minor structures as will not

16 substantially alter the natural character of coastal resources or restrict
 17 access along the public beach; (4) activities conducted for the specific
 18 purpose of conserving or preserving soil, vegetation, water, fish,
 19 shellfish, wildlife and other coastal land and water resources; (5) interior
 20 modifications to buildings; [and] (6) minor changes in use of a building,
 21 structure or property except those changes occurring on property
 22 adjacent to or abutting coastal waters; and (7) construction of a single-
 23 family residential structure except when such structure is (A) located on
 24 an island not connected to the mainland by an existing road bridge or
 25 causeway, or (B) in or within one hundred feet of the following coastal
 26 resource areas: Tidal wetlands, coastal bluffs and escarpments and
 27 beaches and dunes. Gardening, grazing and the harvesting of crops
 28 shall be exempt from the requirements of this chapter. If a zoning
 29 commission adopts an exemption pursuant to subdivision (7) of this
 30 subsection, such commission shall, not less than quarterly, submit a
 31 report to the Commissioner of Energy and Environmental Protection
 32 detailing any such single-family residential structure approved by the
 33 commission during the period covered by such report. Notwithstanding
 34 the provisions of this subsection, shoreline flood and erosion control
 35 structures as defined in subsection (c) of this section shall not be exempt
 36 from the requirements of this chapter.

This act shall take effect as follows and shall amend the following sections:

Section 1	October 1, 2026	22a-109(b)
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Statement of Purpose:

To allow zoning commissions to exempt certain single-family residential structures from requirements concerning coastal site plan reviews and instead submit quarterly reports to the Commissioner of Energy and Environmental Protection concerning the approval of such structures.

[Proposed deletions are enclosed in brackets. Proposed additions are indicated by underline, except that when the entire text of a bill or resolution or a section of a bill or resolution is new, it is not underlined.]